# Stay Safe Online: Essential Checklist for College Students

## Financial & UPI Security

- **Remember the "UPI PIN" rule:** You only need to enter your UPI PIN when *sending* money, never to receive it. If a buyer for your old textbooks or a stranger says they are sending you money but asks for your PIN, it is a scam.
- **Beware of "Part-Time Job" scams:** Be highly skeptical of unsolicited WhatsApp or Telegram messages offering easy money for liking YouTube videos or writing reviews. Never pay an "initial registration fee" or "security deposit" to secure an online gig.
- **Avoid public Wi-Fi for transactions:** Do not pay fees or shop online using free campus or cafe Wi-Fi. Always switch to your mobile network or use a trusted VPN for financial transactions to prevent data interception.

## Social Media & Communications

- **Ignore unknown video calls:** Do not answer unexpected WhatsApp or Instagram video calls from unknown numbers. Scammers often use these to record compromising footage and blackmail students (sextortion scams).
- **Verify before clicking:** Do not click on random links promising "free Netflix/Spotify subscriptions," "leaked exam papers," or "discounted branded gear" forwarded in college WhatsApp groups. These are common phishing tactics used to steal login credentials.
- **Lock down your digital footprint:** Set your Instagram, Facebook, and personal Twitter accounts to private. Be mindful of posting real-time location tags (like your dorm or current hangout spot) to protect your physical safety.

## Account & Device Hygiene

- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Turn on 2FA for your email, university portals, and social media accounts. Even if a hacker guesses your password, they won't be able to log in without the secondary code from your phone.
- **Never share OTPs:** Never share an OTP (One-Time Password) with anyone over the phone, even if they claim to be from your bank, phone provider, or university administration.

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# 🚨 What to do if you are compromised

If you suspect you have been scammed, a victim of financial fraud, or are facing cyberbullying/blackmail, act immediately:

- **Call the National Cybercrime Helpline:** Dial **1930** immediately to report financial fraud. The faster you call, the higher the chance of freezing the stolen funds.
- **File an Official Report:** Register your complaint online at the **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal**: [suspicious link removed].